

King's College London Code of Good Conduct in Research

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1. Introduction

King's College London is committed to the promotion of good conduct and integrity in research. Good research conduct underpins high-quality, high-impact research and ensures trust in King's research. All research undertaken at King's is expected to be conducted with the core values of **honesty, rigour, openness, transparency, care, respect and accountability** in mind, to produce research of the highest standard. These core values are aligned to the commitments of several national frameworks, organisations, and many of our research partners, notably the [Concordat to Support Research Integrity](#) and the [UK Research Integrity Office's Code of Practice](#) which King's proudly embeds alongside our own.

This code of conduct outlines the responsibilities of King's College London and all King's staff and students conducting or involved in research. It acts to signpost the range of existing King's policies that relate to research conduct. Where the code refers to King's policies or external requirements these responsibilities should be considered mandatory if applicable to the type of research being carried out. Where the code refers to responsibilities outside of formal policies, these should be considered as recommendations to inform good research practice.

This code should be viewed as supplementary to existing professional norms, disciplinary standards and other guidance produced by funders, publishers, learned societies,

government agencies and other relevant professional bodies. Additional guidance on research practices may be developed to supplement this policy as and when necessary, both locally within Faculties and centrally within the Research Management and Innovation Directorate.

2. Scope

This Policy applies to all King's staff and students conducting or supporting research under the auspices of King's College London. This includes all visiting staff and students, honorary and adjunct researchers. It applies to all research activities, irrespective of funding source or location. Where research partners do not have their own policies or guidance on good research practices, we will expect this Code to be adopted and adapted to suit the local context.

For the purposes of this policy "research" refers to the Research Excellence Framework (REF) definition: a process of investigation leading to new insights, effectively shared. It includes work of direct relevance to the needs of commerce, industry, culture, society, and to the public and voluntary sectors; scholarship; the invention and generation of ideas, images, performances, artefacts including design, where these lead to new or substantially improved insights; and the use of existing knowledge in experimental development to produce new or substantially improved materials, devices, products and processes, including design and construction. It includes research that is published, disseminated or made publicly available in the form of assessable research outputs, and confidential reports.

This code has been developed with research activities in mind but many of the principles may apply to non-research activities carried out by King's researchers such as service evaluations, audits and contracted services such as consultancy and fee-for-service work. In these cases, researchers must also conform with the relevant policies, processes and guidance for their activities.

3. Institutional responsibilities

3.1. Governance structure

King's College London is committed to ensuring the highest standards of integrity and rigour are maintained in research carried out by its staff and students.

Institutional responsibilities for good research conduct and research quality at King's are overseen by the University's Academic Board. The Board is advised by College Research Committee on strategy and policy affecting research, on quality assurance and regulatory issues and on the sharing of good practice.

Alongside Faculty research support staff, the Research Management & Innovation Directorate (RMID) enables research of the highest quality through dedicated teams of professional

services staff. Collectively they provide support, research infrastructure and services that enable researchers to work effectively, in line with funder requirements and with impact and integrity. Within RMID the dedicated [Research Integrity Office](#) supports all researchers through the provision of training, guidance, the development of relevant policies and procedures on good research conduct and ensures King's meets its commitments as a signatory of the [Concordat to Support Research Integrity](#). To ensure co-ordination with activities within the Faculties, the office manages and supports two [staff networks](#): the Research Integrity Advisor network, which provides all researchers at King's with a local point of contact to speak to for advice and guidance on good research practices; and the Research Integrity Champions network, which is formed of Vice-Deans (Research) or their nominated equivalents who hold responsibility for ensuring that a culture of good practice and research integrity is promoted and embedded within their Faculties.

The Research Integrity Office also works collaboratively with the [Research Culture](#) team and other teams to ensure the research environment at King's supports and promotes good research practice.

3.2. Addressing concerns with research practices

The University is committed to providing an environment in which all staff and students feel comfortable in raising and reporting concerns related to research integrity. Concerns may be managed at a local-level with relevant Faculty-staff with the support of a [Research Integrity Advisor](#) or managed by the Research Integrity Office. The Office may seek or support local resolution where appropriate but serious allegations may be dealt with under the [Procedure for Investigating and Resolving Allegations of Research Misconduct](#).

The University is committed to supporting those raising complaints as well as King's researchers accused of research misconduct. Where allegations are found to be unsubstantiated, proportionate effort will be made to ensure that researchers shall not suffer any loss of reputation or other loss following resolution of the matter.

Where issues relate to breaches in the conduct of clinical research the Research Integrity Office will refer these to the relevant sponsoring organisation(s). Where issues reported also include instances of bullying and harassment or poor professional conduct, the Research Integrity Office will liaise with Human Resources (HR) as per their [Memorandum of Understanding](#). Concerns related to student assessment material will be referred to Student Conduct & Appeals and dealt with under the [Academic Misconduct policy](#).

4. Researcher responsibilities

4.1. Professional conduct

4.1.1. Academic freedom

King's is committed to providing a safe, open and vibrant intellectual environment for the

exchange of ideas and the cultivation of knowledge and intends to offer the widest possible opportunity for freedom of expression. Researchers have the freedom of choosing the topic of their research, their research methodology and route of dissemination. This academic freedom confers responsibilities as well as rights and researchers should be mindful of the standards outlined in this policy as well as any disciplinary norms and standards required of their research. Researchers should be mindful of the dignity and privacy of others, and tolerant of the right of others to exercise their freedom of expression. Further information can be found in the [Policy statement on Academic Freedom at King's](#).

When using social media in a professional capacity, researchers should be mindful of the credibility that an academic title confers and always ensure that their content or commentary falls in line with expected professional standards. Where researchers use social media accounts in both a private and professional capacity, care should be taken to ensure there is an explicit demarcation between the two to avoid reputational damage.

4.1.2. Raising concerns around research practices

Concerns about potential breaches of good research conduct in King's research (excluding student assessments) should be raised at a local-level with relevant Faculty-staff or with a [Research Integrity Advisor](#) or raised with the Research Integrity Office at research-integrity@kcl.ac.uk. The Office may seek or support local resolution where appropriate but serious allegations may be dealt with under the [Procedure for Investigating and Resolving Allegations of Research Misconduct](#). Where issues relate to breaches in the conduct of clinical research these must be reported to the relevant sponsoring organisation(s) as required by Good Clinical Practice (GCP) guidance.

For details of where to raise other conduct related complaints, including whistleblowing, please see the [King's concerns and complaints webpage](#).

Where errors or concerns are identified in published work, researchers should work to correct the error and notify the journal or publisher as soon as possible. Where substantive concerns with published work are reported to the University, the Research Integrity Office may investigate these under the Procedure for Investigating and Resolving Allegations of Research Misconduct.

4.1.3. Interpersonal conduct

Conduct towards other researchers, staff and students is an important aspect of good research practice. Incidents of bullying and harassment are understood to have a significant, negative impact on research integrity and wider research culture. In line with [Dignity at King's Prevention of Bullying, Harassment and Sexual Misconduct Policy](#) researchers should treat others with respect, courtesy, consideration and actively promote a working and learning environment that is free from bullying and harassment. Researchers should be mindful of power dynamics, hierarchies and cultural differences between other researchers, staff members, students, participants of research and members of the public. All managers, supervisors and Heads of Departments have a responsibility to deal with reports of bullying

and harassment in line with the Dignity at King's Policy. Concerns can be reported through [Report and Support](#) or directly with [HR](#).

4.1.4. Supervision and management of researchers or students

Supervisors, managers and research leaders must ensure that a culture of good research practice is fostered within their departments and research groups. They should be aware of their responsibility to demonstrate high standards of conduct and exemplify these standards as role models for more junior researchers. Supervisors and managers must ensure that all researchers under their supervision are aware of and meet any relevant regulatory, ethical and legal requirements of their research.

Supervisors of Post-Graduate Research (PGR) students should be aware of the [Supervisory Best Practice](#) guidance as outlined by King's Doctoral College. All newly appointed members of staff with responsibilities for supervision are required to attend the University's New Supervisor Introductory Workshop, and all supervisors are required to undertake refresher training at least once every 5 years.

4.1.5. Training & professional development

Researchers should take a proactive approach to their professional development, alongside identifying and addressing any training needs. King's is a signatory of the [Concordat to Support the Career Development of Researchers](#), and researchers are encouraged to engage in a minimum of 10 days of professional development pro rata per year. Supervisors, managers and senior staff members have a responsibility to support and encourage the development of researchers. Managers of researchers must ensure their teams complete annual Performance Development Reviews.

Any mandatory training such as Good Clinical Practice or health and safety training must be completed and refreshed as and when required.

4.1.6. Safeguarding

The University expects all university staff, students, and associated personnel representing the University or who contribute to its activities to follow the guidance on safeguarding and to promote the welfare of children and adults at risk. Researchers must make themselves aware of the local safeguarding policies and procedures within their areas and any partner organisations in their research, as well as the [King's Safeguarding Policy](#).

Researchers working with vulnerable groups or children will need to apply for a Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS) check. Further information can be found on the Research Governance team's [webpages on safeguarding and DBS checks](#).

For research conducted outside of the UK, further local safeguarding checks or processes may be required in the country of research. It is the research team's responsibility to confirm and secure any further non-UK security clearances prior to the research commencing. Researchers

must be aware of and follow the [Safeguarding Protocol for International Projects, Research and Partnerships](#).

4.2. Research assurance & compliance

4.2.1. Research governance

Researchers must ensure they are aware of and comply with any local, national and international regulations, including those set by ethics committees, regulatory bodies, and research organisations. This includes external funder requirements where relevant such as, reporting requirements, publishing or open access requirements or bullying and harassment policies. Researchers must ensure that themselves and any researchers that they manage or supervise, are appropriately trained and qualified to undertake the tasks required of their research. For quality assurance purposes, all researchers must adopt rigorous data collection methods and review processes, and permit access for sponsor, organisational or funder audits as required. Whilst all researchers are responsible for ensuring that their work complies with applicable research governance requirements including laws, regulations, and institutional policies, Principal Investigators hold primary responsibility for ensuring that the teams or laboratories they lead comply with all applicable governance requirements, even where certain tasks have been delegated to more junior team members.

Researchers should adhere to best practice recommendations and any regulatory or funder requirements around transparency of results and reproducibility. For example, publication in open access journals and registration of trials and outcomes on public access databases.

For research involving patients and participants, researchers must prioritise patient and participant safety and ensure that any requirements of the relevant approving Research Ethics Committee and regulatory bodies are met. Researchers should have appropriate oversight, and clear delegation of roles and responsibilities to ensure appropriate monitoring for any adverse events, ensure the trial protocol minimises risk, and promptly report any incidents or concerns in line with the guidance provided on the [Research Governance Office website](#). These processes and reporting mechanisms must be agreed and documented with the relevant sponsor/co-sponsor prior to the study commencing. Researchers should involve participants in planning of the appropriate dissemination of results and put in place mechanisms for ensuring participants can access results of research they have taken time to participate in.

Researchers must ensure compliance with any relevant regulatory requirements including but not limited to: [Human Tissue Act \(2004\)](#), [Mental Capacity Act \(2005\)](#), [Animals \(Scientific Procedures Act 1986\) \(ASPA\)](#) and [Amendment Regulations 2012](#), [Data Protection Act \(2018\)](#), [Export Control Order \(2008\)](#), [National Security and Investment Act \(2021\)](#), [The Medicines for Human Use \(Clinical Trials\) Regulations \(2004\)](#) and [Health and Safety at Work Act \(1974\)](#).

4.2.2. Disclosure of interests

To protect the integrity and reputation of King's staff and ensure that personal interactions with external parties do not disadvantage the University, researchers must follow the [Disclosure of Interests Policy and Procedure](#). Where real or perceived conflicts of interest are identified these must be managed appropriately in line with the Disclosures of Interests Procedure, and disclosed where required to funders, journals and partners.

4.2.3. Intellectual property & licensing

Researchers should be aware of the [Intellectual Property, Commercial Exploitation & Financial Benefits Code of Practice](#). This code enables suitable protection of intellectual property that is of public interest and/or of commercial value so it can be appropriately disseminated, including through commercial exploitation where this may enhance the impact of the research. For further information see the [Intellectual Property & Licensing Team's webpages](#).

4.2.4. Health and safety

In line with the [Health, Safety, Welfare and Fire Safety Policy](#), researchers are responsible for following University, Faculty, Directorate or other local arrangements for health and safety, as well as ensuring they take reasonable care of the health, safety and fire safety of themselves and others who may be affected by their activities or omissions. University-level policy and guidance can be found on the [Health & Safety Management System - SMS Home](#). Managers, supervisors and Heads of Department are expected to implement their Faculty or Directorate's health, safety and fire safety management arrangements, and to monitor and check their effectiveness. Faculty or Directorate arrangements may include the use of risk assessments or Standard Operating Procedures, and additional processes may need to be put in place for research activities that involve offsite or lone working.

All researchers must complete mandatory training related to their activities through the [Compliance E-learning system](#) (mandatory courses will vary depending on role and activities).

4.2.5. Environmental sustainability and protection of the environment

As part of King's commitment to environmental sustainability, and in line with the [Environmental Sustainability Policy](#) and the [UKRI Concordat for Environmental Sustainability](#), researchers are expected to consider and mitigate the environmental impact of their research activities. Where relevant, researchers should: minimise energy and water consumption; prioritise the use of existing research equipment before purchasing new equipment; ensure the appropriate disposal of laboratory waste; optimise research space usage to reduce energy consumption including efficient use of specialist laboratory environments; ensure best practice in management of cold storage; opt for low-carbon alternatives; and consider the [Sustainable Travel Policy](#) when choosing travel options. Laboratory-based researchers are encouraged to participate in sustainability initiatives managed by the [Sustainable Research](#)

[Team](#), and all laboratories should be accredited through the [Laboratory Efficiency Assessment Framework \(LEAF\)](#) to bronze level as a minimum. Researchers involved in data or computationally intensive research, are encouraged to engage in the Digital Sustainability Certification, GreenDiSC. For more information on sustainable computing and the GreenDiSC scheme please see the [e-Research Team's webpages](#).

4.2.6. Collaborations

Where research is being conducted collaboratively, particularly within interdisciplinary or international partnerships and irrespective of funding source, researchers should ensure clear recorded agreement on the standards, terms and frameworks that will apply to the work. Agreements should be reached on how costs and rewards will be shared, on ownership and access to data, on responsibility for securing the required approvals and permissions and on dissemination and authorship of research outputs.

Where collaborations involve international partners, researchers must be aware of and follow the [Safeguarding Protocol for International Projects, Research and Partnerships](#). When collaborating with partners in low- and middle-income countries, King's researchers should carefully consider how power dynamics and inequities will be transparently managed and mitigated. Further additional guidance is available in the [Montreal Statement on Research Integrity in Cross-Boundary Research Collaborations](#), [The Cape Town Statement on Fostering Research Integrity through Fairness and Equity](#) and the [NIHR Equitable Partnerships Guide](#). All collaborations, irrespective of the source of funding, must follow the expected procedures as outlined in the [Policy & Procedures on Administration of Research Grants and Contracts](#).

4.2.7. Trusted research

'Trusted research' describes the UK government's agenda to protect the UK's intellectual property, sensitive research, people and infrastructure from potential theft, manipulation and exploitation, including because of interference by hostile actors. The Trusted Research Committee will facilitate King's compliance with related legislation and provide a support model to ensure that researchers have the necessary tools and knowledge to meet the requirements of trusted research. Researchers engaged in international collaborations, security sensitive research, or technology which may be regulated by the [Export Control Order 2008](#) should be aware of the [National Security and Investment Act 2021 \(NSIA 2021\)](#) and [King's International Regulations Policy and Guidance](#). Further guidance can be found on the [King's Trusted Research](#) webpages.

Researchers engaged in activities where they act on behalf of a foreign government or state-controlled entity to influence UK politics, policy, or public life are required to comply with the Foreign Influence Registration Scheme (FIRS) under the [National Security Act 2023](#). Further information can be found on the [FIRS webpages](#).

4.2.8. Management of research funding

Where research is externally funded, researchers must be aware of and abide by the [Research Grants & Contracts Policy](#). This covers the requirements for: costing and pricing research projects; drafting and negotiating contracts and collaboration/consortium agreements; data, publication, risk and IP management; approving research proposals prior to submission; signing and accepting all research awards and contracts; issuing research activity codes; authorisation of staff recruitment; invoicing, profile payments and financial reporting; managing audit reviews of research activity codes; and credit control relating to external research funding. Research funds must be managed in line with King's regulations and procedures as well as with the funder's terms and conditions. Misuse of research funds could be considered a breach of good research practice and may be investigated under the Procedure for Investigating and Resolving Allegations of Research Misconduct.

4.2.9. Generative AI and other emerging technologies

Researchers should be aware of the King's [Guidance for Responsible Use of Generative AI in Research](#) and follow any additional policies of relevant funders and journals. Due to the fast-moving nature of Generative AI and other emerging technologies researchers should be particularly careful to ensure they refer to and follow up-to-date guidance.

4.2.10. Research design & methodology

The initial stages of designing a research project are an essential time to consider several aspects of good practice as outlined in this code. Researchers should consider practical requirements such as planning for relevant data storage and management, ensuring there will be appropriate resources and expertise and how to meet any relevant regulatory or legal requirements. Alongside practical requirements, researchers should consider how open research practices can be incorporated into their project and how issues of rigour, transparency and reproducibility can be addressed. Research methodology should be appropriate for the research questions being posed and recorded in appropriate detail.

4.3. Openness and dissemination of research

4.3.1. Open research

King's strongly encourages all researchers to adopt open research practices to facilitate the sharing of research data, materials, methods, protocols, software, code and outputs. Researchers should contribute to and promote a culture of openness with the aim of improving transparency of research, building public trust and allowing a broader exploitation of research findings. Researchers should consider the FAIR Guiding Principles for scientific data management and stewardship to improve the Findability, Accessibility, Interoperability, and Reuse of digital assets (the FAIR principles are often consolidated into the understanding that your research data should be, "as open as possible; as closed as necessary"). Researchers should be aware of any funder requirements for open research and the [Concordat on Open](#)

[Research Data](#). The University's [Open Research Team](#) (based within Libraries and Collections) and Research Governance Team (in RMID) provide support around these considerations.

Researchers should comply with the [Research Publications Policy](#) which affirms the requirements of the Research England policy on open access and those of external funders where open access publishing is mandated. The policy outlines the King's rights retention strategy, whereby upon acceptance of publication King's asserts a non-exclusive, irrevocable, worldwide licence to make manuscripts of authors' scholarly articles publicly available. In line with this, the policy also requires researchers to take responsibility for the creation of bibliographic records within King's institutional repository and CRIS system, Pure, for all research outputs they have authored. To improve discoverability and transparency in reporting the policy also requires researchers to use a persistent author identifier – such as an ORCID ID, when submitting author details for a publication and requires researchers to add a data accessibility statement to research outputs.

4.3.2. Research data management

Researchers must follow the King's Data Management [Policy and Procedure](#), which ensures research data is managed in compliance with legal, ethical, regulatory, contractual and Intellectual Property Rights (IPR) requirements through its lifecycle.

Researchers are encouraged to use [LabArchives](#), a centrally supported electronic research notebook for better data management, reproducibility, sustainability, and sample tracking.

Researchers must retain research data in line with the Record Retention Schedule limits and any external funder or journal requirements. Further guidance on retention of research data can be found in the [supplementary guidance on retention of research data](#).

Research Data Management is supported by [Libraries & Collections](#) at King's.

4.3.3. Research impact

Research impact refers to the influence of research findings on broader society beyond academia. Researchers are encouraged to plan for impact from the outset of the research project to maximise opportunities for positive impact and mitigate unintended negative consequences. Identifying and collaborating with relevant stakeholders throughout the research cycle and employing frameworks like the Theory of Change can help determine appropriate actions to drive impact. It is recommended that these actions are evaluated continuously, collecting evidence of what has worked, identifying what hasn't, and taking steps as needed to address any issues. Although impact activities do not often require formal ethical clearance, they should adhere to the highest ethical and research integrity standards. For more information and support visit the [Research Impact Hub](#).

4.3.4. Dissemination of research

Researchers have professional responsibility to disseminate research findings. Researchers should be aware that the dissemination is one of the criteria of the Charity Commission for King's to retain its "Exempt Charity" status. Research outputs should be disseminated in an appropriate format in line with disciplinary norms and standards. Reasonable efforts should be made to maximise research impact, ensure dissemination occurs within a reasonable timeframe of project completion and to ensure accurate and transparent reporting. Researchers must comply with any additional criteria for dissemination as stipulated by funders or journals. Researchers should ensure that open research and open access considerations have been considered as outlined in section 4.3.1. Open Research.

Researchers should be aware of the [Institutional Affiliation & Acknowledgement of Funders Policy](#) and must ensure appropriate institutional affiliations and funding acknowledgments in research outputs.

4.3.5. Authorship and CRediT

Researchers should engage in open and ongoing discussions regarding authorship and acknowledgement of contributions at the early stages of research projects. Criteria and order of authorship should be agreed collectively by all contributors and align with the publisher guidelines or other disciplinary norms where these apply. In the absence of such guidelines, the recommendations from the [International Committee of Medical Journal Editors](#) may be useful to refer to.

Researchers should be aware of the [King's Guidance on Authorship and the Recognition of Contributions](#) which recommends researchers use the CRediT taxonomy in all research outputs to increase the visibility of individual contributions, to ensure the fair and ethical allocation of contributor and author roles, and to promote a culture of constructive collaboration, transparency, and accountability. Researchers should be aware of and comply with the [Fair Publication Policy](#) and ensure that research facility staff and other technical staff members are afforded appropriate acknowledgement for their contributions to research outputs.

4.3.6. Peer review

Peer review is an integral part of the research process in both dissemination and review of research, it includes reviews of research grant applications, publications and ethics applications. Researchers are encouraged to become peer reviewers. Where research projects are not subject to external peer review, such as unfunded or philanthropically funded research, it is recommended that researchers seek internal peer review through their Faculty.

Researchers must follow the guidelines and regulations of the organisation they are peer reviewing for, including any requirements on confidentiality and declaring conflicts of interest. Researchers must not take advantage of any information received as a result of their

peer reviewing role. Further guidance can be found in the [COPE Ethical Guidelines for Peer Reviewers](#).

4.4. Research engaging people or involving animals or biological materials

4.4.1. Public and stakeholder engagement in research

Where appropriate, researchers should consider whether Patient and Public Involvement (PPI), participatory or co-produced research could improve the quality, relevance or impact of their research. Further information and support can be found on the [King's PPI Hub](#). Although ethical clearance is not typically required for PPI or co-production activities, researchers must still consider the principles of ethical research such as practices of informed consent and the duty of care towards contributors. If it is determined that there is a risk that contributors may experience distress or anxiety, researchers should consider applying for ethical clearance. Further support and guidance can be found on the [Public and Community Engagement with Research webpages](#) and sought from the [Research Ethics Office](#).

4.4.2. Research ethics & ethical clearance

The research ethics process requires researchers to consider and manage ethical issues such as the management of risk to participants through the research process or from the outputs of the research, protection of confidentiality and the process of informed consent. Ethical clearance is required for all primary data collection involving human participants and certain types of research involving pre-existing human data/tissues. Research involving healthy volunteers (non-NHS patients) and/or their tissue or data (where the data is identifiable and not in the public domain) requires ethical clearance prior to the commencement of data collection. This process is overseen by the King's Research Ethics Office and the King's Research Governance Office. In some cases, external ethical review may be required.

Research undertaken at King's that involves the collection or reuse of personally identifiable data must be registered in REMAS before data collection (or analysis in the case of pre-existing datasets) begins. For research involving NHS patients, resources and/or their data, ethical approval must be sought through the HRA and relevant NHS Ethics Committee. Further information and guidance can be found in the [Research Ethics Policy](#), the [Research Ethics Office's webpages](#) and the [Research Governance Office's](#) webpages. Where researchers intend to use human tissue, they must have full ethical approval and Participant Informed Consent forms in place where required by the HTA. For research involving animals please see section 4.4.3. Animal research.

4.4.3. Animal research

All research projects that involve the use of living animals must be reviewed by the King's Animal Welfare & Ethical Review Bodies (AWERBs). This committee will determine if the requirements under the [King's College London policy on the use of animals in scientific research](#) and Animals (Scientific Procedures) Act 1986 and Amendment Regulations 2012 are

met, and if so, the application will be formally submitted to the Home Office for approval. Researchers must have a valid project licence and personal licence in place before any work with animals begins. All experiments involving regulated procedures must also undergo internal study plan approval. King's research projects that include animal experiments being carried at other UK establishments and/or overseas must be assessed by Biological Services during the grant application process.

The 'Culture of Care' involves a King's-wide commitment to improving animal welfare, scientific quality, care of staff, and transparency for all stakeholders, including the public. Researchers engaged in work that involves the use of living animals should be aware of the [Concordat on Openness on Animal Research in the UK](#), of which King's is a signatory.

4.4.4. Biological safety

All new projects involving Genetically Modified Organisms (GMOs), Genetically Modified Micro Organisms (GMMs), Biological Agents (BAs) and Other Potentially Infectious Material (OPIM) must be risk assessed using a Combined Biological Risk Assessment form, typically completed by the Principal Investigator with the assistance of the local Biological Safety Supervisor. Completed forms must be reviewed by the relevant Faculty Biological Safety Committee and, where necessary, must be notified to the Health and Safety Executive before the study is authorised to commence. For more information on who your local Biological Safety Committee is and to access a Combined Biological Risk Assessment form please see the [internal biosafety webpages](#).

4.4.5. Nagoya Protocol

The [Nagoya Protocol on Access and Benefit-Sharing](#) aims to ensure the fair and equitable sharing of the benefits arising from the utilisation of genetic resources. It applies to researchers using non-human genetic material from another country. Researchers must comply with the relevant national access regulations in the country providing the resource in question. In addition, an agreement must be drawn up that ensures that the provider of the resource enjoys a fair and equitable share of the benefits (e.g. profits, technologies, know-how) arising from its utilisation. For further guidance please see the [internal webpages on the Nagoya Protocol](#).